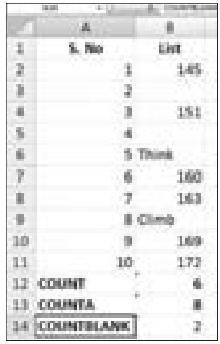

An Example of COUNT functions

can, as in other cases, refer to a cell range or a named range. The criteria argument can take many forms—some of which are explained below.

=COUNTIF(A1:D10,7)
Counts all the cells in the range A1 to D10 with the number 7

=COUNTIF(A1:D10,"Delhi")
Counts all the cells in the range with the text Delhi. Any text or expression should be enclosed in quotes—e.g.: "<13", "<>234","Digit" etc

=COUNTIF(A1:D10,C7)
Counts all the cells in the range which matches the contents of the cell C7.

=COUNTIF(A1:D10,"<>"&C7)
When you want to use operators other than equality then you need to use quotes for the operator and join it to the cell reference using the & (ampersand) symbol. Thus in the above expression Excel will return a count of all the cells where the content "is not equal to" the content in cell C7.

=COUNTIF(A1:D10,"*milk")
=COUNTIF(A1:D10,"*orange*")
=COUNTIF(A1:D10,"??eat")

Using wildcard operators is another powerful way to extract information from texts in cells. There are two wild card operators, * and ?. The asterisk (*) specifies to search for any text while the question mark (?) specifies to search for a specific length of text characters. In the first example above, Excel searches for all cells in the range ending with the text milk—e.g. chocolate milk, rose milk, etc. In the second example Excel searches for all text in the range containing the text orange—e.g. florida oranges, orange